

Your name:



The UK Linguistics Olympiad 2022 - Round 2

Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 38)

1.1: Max 4 – 1 per correct word

1.2 Max 16 – 2 per correct word

1.3 Max 18 – 2 per correct stress assignment, 1 per correct translation. Accept translations with the same meaning. Accept any 3rd person pronoun(s) for *s/he, it*.

Q 1.1	(a) ýna	Q 1.2	(a) mapu-cé	(e) wenu-mápu
	(b) pupnúja		(b) lypí-acawál	(f) foró-całwa
	(c) łafkén		(c) kyčal-kó	(g) łoηkó-moyo
	(d) píwke		(d) θomó-lamηén	(h) ciłkatuwe-rúka
Q 1.3	(a) leliηélawán <i>I will not be watched</i>	(d) jenékelawáj <i>s/he will not usually be brought</i>		
	(b) jenélajmi <i>you are not brought</i>	(e) θewmakéjmi <i>you usually make</i>		
	(c) čipálawán <i>I will not go out</i>	(f) yčyfýmkelawafij <i>s/he will not usually cause it to throw</i>		

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Commentary

We describe three stress rules, used to assign stress to a segment X:

- a) If X is monosyllabic, X is stressed
- b) Else if the final syllable of X is closed, stress the final syllable
- c) Else stress the penultimate syllable.

In simplex nouns, apply rules (a)-(c).

In compound nouns, stress the final syllable of the first element, and apply (a)-(c) to the second. If two stressed syllables are adjacent, discard the stress in the modifying noun and keep the stress in the head noun.

In verbs, stress the final syllable of the root, stress a voice suffix if present, then apply (a)-(c) to the other affixes. If two stressed syllables are adjacent, discard a stress in the root, and keep the stress in a voice suffix.

The verb has the following form:

ROOT	VOICE SUFFIX	ASPECT	POLARITY	TENSE	OBJECT	SUBJECT
	-ym causative -ŋe passive	-ke habitual	-la negative	-wa future	-fi 3s	-n 1s -jmi 2s -j 3s

An alternative analysis of the verb treats it in the same way as a compound noun, with the first part being the root + voice affixes, and the second part being the remaining suffixes. The “head” is then usually the second part, unless there is a voice suffix present.

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Scoring: (max 33)

2.1: Max 19 - 1 point each

2.2: Max 6 - 2 points per correct answer. In (b), award 1 point for crab's innards, middle of the crab etc.

2.3: Max 8 – 2 points for (a) and (b); 4 points for (c). In (c), award 2 points for **way kuchek**.

Q 2.1	1 Q	6 R	11 J	16 C
	2 O	7 G	12 M	17 D
	3 E	8 S	13 I	18 N
	4 P	9 F	14 B	19 K
	5 H	10 A	15 L	
Q 2.2	(a) <i>spear</i>		(b) <i>crab heart</i> <i>[Accept heart of the crab, etc.]</i>	(c) <i>bad</i>
Q 2.3	(a) ek		(b) ma'	(c) kuchek way

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Commentary

Wik-Mungkan	English	Literal translation
1. kek kuchek	Q. <i>top of spear</i>	spear-head
2. kuchek thayan	O. <i>stubborn</i>	head-firm
3. ma' ek	E. <i>finger nail</i>	hand-shell
4. ma' puk pi'an	P. <i>thumb</i>	hand-child-big
5. ma' puuy	H. <i>handcuffs</i>	hand-crab
6. ma' thayan	R. <i>trustworthy (with things)</i>	hand-firm
7. min	G. <i>good</i>	
8. ngak	S. <i>water</i>	
9. ngak min	F. <i>fresh water</i>	water-good
10. ngak way	A. <i>alcohol</i>	water-bad
11. ngangk	J. <i>heart</i>	
12. ngangk ek	M. <i>shoulder blade</i>	heart-shell
13. ngangk min	I. <i>happy</i>	heart-good
14. ngangk thayan	B. <i>brave</i>	heart-firm
15. ngangk way	L. <i>sad</i>	heart-bad
16. puuy	C. <i>crab</i>	
17. puuy ek	D. <i>crab shell</i>	crab-shell
18. thayan	N. <i>strong, firm</i>	
19. wik thayan	K. <i>law</i>	word-firm

In nominal compounds, the order is modifier + head. Else, the order is noun + adjective.

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 54)

Q 3.1: Max 12 - In each main clause and bracketed relative clause: award 2 points if correct, 1 point with one mistake. If the relative clause is misplaced, treat that as a mistake in the relative clause.

E.g., "(b) *The teacher has also washed him, who I caught*" gains 2 for the main clause, 1 for the relative.

In (c) only mark one answer, and award the highest number of possible marks.

Q 3.2: Max 18 - In each main clause and bracketed relative clause: 3 marks if all correct, 2 marks if one mistake, 1 mark if two mistakes. If the relative clause is misplaced, treat that as a mistake in the relative clause.

E.g., "(c) **Ne tā he faiaoga e vaka ne kitia e Mele**" gains 3 for the main clause, 2 for the relative.

Q 3.1	(a) <i>There are only birds.</i> (Max 2)
	(b) <i>The teacher [that I caught] has also washed him.</i> (Max 4)
	(c) <i>The child [that the bird saw] will have plenty of canoes [that Sione will wash.]</i> <i>The child [that the bird [that Sione will wash] saw] will have plenty of canoes.</i> <i>The child will have plenty of canoes [that the bird [that Sione will wash] saw.]</i> (Max 6)
Q 3.2	(a) To totou foki a ia. (Max 3)
	(b) Kua fai ika noa a Sione [ka kai he faiaoga]. (Max 6)
	(c) Ne tā he faiaoga [ne kitia e Mele] e vaka. (Max 6)
	(d) Kua muhu kāmuta tūmau. (Max 3)

Q 3.3: Max 24 – Broken down as follows:

Basic syntax: 3

Relative clauses: 3

Tense marking: 3

Case marking: 6

Existential verbs: 4

Fronting: 5

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Commentary

- The default word order is *Tense + Verb + (Adverb) + Subject + Object*
- Tense markers are as follows:

Past	ne
Perfect	kua
Present	∅
Future	to

- Nouns must be preceded by a case marker:

	Ergative	Absolutive
Name / Pronoun	e	a
Else	he	e

- The ergative is used for the subject of a relative clause, or a subject if it is followed by an object; the absolutive is used elsewhere.
- They can be followed by a relative clause.
 - Relative clauses are introduced by **ne** if the clause is in the past tense, and **ka** in the future, then follow typical syntax.
- Verbs come in two types: existential verbs, **fai** *be/have* and **muhu** *be/have plenty*; and general verbs.
 - Existential verbs are translated as *there + be* without a subject, and as *have* with a subject.
 - The object is compulsory. The head noun is moved to come directly after the verb, and does not appear with case markers. Relative clauses stay in the object position.
 - Note that existential verbs are always treated as intransitive, i.e., subjects of existential verbs are absolutive.

Massam (2001), *Pseudo Noun Incorporation in Niuean*: <http://www.jstor.org/stable/404791>.

Massam (2000), *VSO and VOS: Aspects of Niuean Word Order*. In Andrew Carnie and Eithne Guilfoyle (eds), *The Syntax of Verb Initial Languages*.

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Solution and marking.

Scoring: (max 85)

4.1: Max 8 - 4 points per correct option. Award 0 points if more than 2 are marked.

4.2: Max 27 – For each answer: 3 points if correct, 1 point with one mistake (length, quality, tone, onset, coda OR extra form)

4.3 Max 50 – For each answer: 5 points if correct, 2 points with one mistake (extra form, missing form, length, quality, tone, etc...)

Q 4.1	àdèen	
	mìiit	
	wèeet	
	tôon	X
	jàak	
	tûun	X

Cross the correct options (X) and leave the incorrect options blank.

Q 4.2	(a) lòoj	(d) càam	(g) wjèec
	(b) lòooj	(e) pèec	(h) bòk
	(c) càam	(f) pèeec	(i) bwòck
Q 4.3	(j) réen, rón	(n) rjéem	(r) jîit
	(k) wjèeel, wîiil	(o) kwòck	(s) àjéer
	(l) réec	(p) lèek, lêeek	
	(m) kál, kól	(q) rwòcl	

Q 4.4: Max 95 – Broken down as follows:

Noun tone/length patterns: 15

Verb tone/length patterns: 5

Noun vowel patterns: 50

Verb vowel patterns: 25

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Commentary

Vowels come in 6 qualities and 3 grades:

Grade 1	i	e	a	ɔ	o	u
Grade 2	i	e	ɛ	ɔ	o	u
Grade 3	jɛ	ɛ	a	a	wɔ	wo

Singular and plural patterns then correspond by changing the final vowel as follows, with subscripts indicating vowel grades:

- $\acute{V}_1 - \grave{V}V_3$
- $\acute{V}V_3 - \acute{V}_1$
- $\grave{V}V_1 - \hat{V}V_2$
- $\grave{V}VV_3 - \acute{V}V_2$
- $\hat{V}VV_1 - \acute{V}V_2$

In the verbs the pattern is

- Unmarked: $\hat{V}_1$ or $\hat{V}V_1$
- 1st person: $\hat{V}V_3$ or $\hat{V}VV_3$
- 3rd person: $\hat{V}V_2$ or $\hat{V}VV_2$

You may notice certain patterns in the grades. Treating grade 1 as the base, the for all vowels except a, grades 1 and 2 are the same, while grade 3 is lowered. For a, grades 1 and 3 are the same, and grade 2 is raised.

NB: many analyses of the patterns are available, such as proposing only two types of change (here Grades 1 to 3 and 3 to 2) with two different underlying vowels that realise as **a**.

Dinka also features a distinction between “creaky” and “breathy” vowels, but to simplify this problem, it has not been marked.

Source: [Number-- constructions and semantics : case studies from Africa, Amazonia, India and Oceania \[electronic resource\]](#)

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Scoring: (max 46)

5.1 Max 8 – In each region separated by +, award 1 point if correct.

5.2 Max 12 – For each answer: award 3 points if all correct, 2 points if one mistake, 1 point if two mistakes OR one word correct (even with the other having more than 2 mistake).

Q 5.1	(a) <i>Their people + saw the cedars.</i>
	(b) <i>His deer + hit the mother.</i>
	(c) <i>His cedars + hit the people.</i>
	(d) <i>The sparrows + waited for the deers.</i>
Q 5.2	(a) kəmp'jwnemə ipikaxi
	(b) p'ine ipikimɯ
	(c) kiwcine iwp'imɯ
	(d) ipəna p'ɔyxi

5.3 Max 26 – Broken down as follows:

Syntax: 4

Possession marking: 4

Class agreement: 8

Verb agreement: 10

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Commentary

- Nouns are classified by number, animacy and class.
 - Animate nouns are **ka** mother, **pɛ** deer, **p'iw** sparrow, **p'qy** brother, **t'oy** person.
 - Inanimate nouns are **ci** eye, **hɥ** cedar, **ki** blanket, **p'i** head.
 - Class is decided as follows:

	Singular	Plural
Animate	A	B
Inanimate	B	C

- A subject noun is then structured as follows:

POSSESSOR	CLASS PREFIX	STEM	CLASS SUFFIX
None: ∅ 1p: ki 2s: kɔ 3s: ɔ 3p: i	Not possessed: ∅ Class A: ∅ Class B: m Class C: w		Class A: na Class B: nema Class C: ne

- The verb agrees for the number of the subject, and the class of the object.
- The verb is structured as follows.

AGREEMENT PREFIX	OBJECT	STEM
Sg > A: ∅ Sg > B: i (Sg > C: u) Pl > A: i Pl > B: ipi Pl > C: iw		saw: mɥ hit: mɔt'ɛ waited for: xi

- Note that some inanimate nouns take Class A in the singular, or take **-nɔ** for **-nema** but these do not feature in the problem.

Sources:

An Outline of Taos Grammar, George Trager, in Linguistic structures of native America

Taos II: Pronominal Reference, George Trager

Taos IV: Morphemics, Syntax, Semology in Nouns and in Pronominal Reference, George Trager